INCH-POUND

MIL-T-44427(GL)
29 July 1991

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TENT, FIVE SOLDIER CREW

This specification is approved for use by the Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of a frame supported five soldier crew tent equipped with a frame, tent, pins, liner, fly and a gear net.

1.2 Classification. The tents shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Tent assembly with reversible (Green/Tan) fly
Type II - Tent assembly with reversible (Green/White) fly

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5017 by using the Standardization Documents Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8340

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-F-44425 - Frame Section, Tent, Five Soldier Crew

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

5-4-7581 - Five Soldier Crew Tent Assembly
5-4-7676 - Instr Label, Five Soldier Crew Tent
5-4-7678 - FSCT Pegs, Bag & Contents

(Copies of drawings are available from the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: STRNC-UX, Natick, MA 01760-5017.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Materials and components. Materials and components shall be as specified on the applicable drawings. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the applicable drawings and as specified herein.

3.3.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all type 301 stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1/2 inch in accordance with the required stitch pattern.

3.3.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during the stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1 inch (1/2 inch for box-x and W-W stitching) from the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1 inch from the defective area, (1/2 inch for box-x and W-W stitching), continue over the defective area, and continue a minimum of 1 inch (1/2 inch for box-x and W-W stitching) beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching.

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Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

3.3.1.2 Type 401 stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. Both ends of all seams or stitching produced with 401 stitch type, when not turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching, shall have a 1/2 to 3/4 inch chain extending beyond each end. The looper (underthread) shall always be on the inside of fabric assemblies. All repairs shall be made in accordance with 3.3.1.1a or 3.3.1.1b. Repairs may be made using a 301 stitch type.

3.3.1.3 Bartacking. Bartacking shall be free of thread breaks and loose stitching.

3.3.1.4 Automatic stitching. Automatic stitching machines may be used to perform any of the required stitch patterns provided the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met: and at least three or more tying, overlapping, or back stitches are used to secure the ends of stitching.

3.3.1.5 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/4 inch.

3.3.1.6 Lubrication of thread. There shall be no lubrication of the thread, on the tent and fly prior to or during the sewing operations (see 4.4.2).

3.3.2 Setting of grommets. Holes shall be prepunched to receive the grommets. Holes prepunched to receive the grommets shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the grommet barrel so that the barrel must be forced through the hole. The grommet shall be securely clinched without cutting the adjacent material.

3.3.3 Wicking of sewing thread. There shall be no wicking of water through the tent body or fly stitching when the tent is tested as specified in 4.4.5. The cup test is intended to insure that non-wicking thread has been utilized and that no lubrication has been added to the thread prior to or during the sewing operation.

3.3.1.1 Leaking of taped seams. There shall be no leakage of water through seams requiring seam tapes when the tent is tested as specified in 4.4.5.

3.4 Repairs. Repairs such as mends, darns, patches, or splices are permitted only where specified on the applicable drawings.

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3.5 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.3, shall be removed from production and replaced with nondefective and properly matched components.

3.6 Erection/striking of tent. The complete tent assembly shall be capable of being erected/struck when tested as specified in 4.4.5.

3.7 Workmanship. The tent shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless otherwise disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for ensuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point, or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to ensure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.1 and 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4 and shall be tested as specified in 4.4.5. The erection/striking test, (see 4.5.2), shall be performed for ten complete erect/strike cycles for the first article inspection only. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspeciton. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection of subassemblies shall be made to ascertain that construction details which cannot be examined in the finished product are in accordance with specified requirements. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance, any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

a. There shall be no lubrication of the thread prior to or during the sewing operations for compliance with 3.3.1.6

b. Holes punched to receives grommets are in compliance with 3.3.2

4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The tents shall be examined in an erected position to make the interior easily accessible for examination. The lot size shall be expressed in units of tents. The sample unit shall be one tent. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 10 for major defects, 25 for major and minor A combined defects, and 100 for total (major, minor A, and minor B combined) defects.

TABLE I. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Grommets	Improperly set; two or more teeth exposed			301
	Set with barrel inserted from outside in lieu of inside at any location		201	
	Clinches loosely, allowing grommet to rotate in hole			302
	Clinched excessively tight, cutting fabric	101		

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Reinforcements, general	Any reinforcement not caught in stitching or binding tape as specified	102		
	Improperly assembled to body	103		
	Causing excessive fullness on reinforcements or reinforced parts, improperly applied			303
Transparent seam tape	Incorrectly applied, peeling off or burnt through	104		
Binding	Loosely applied exposing edge of material	105		
	Loosely applied but not exposing edge of material			304
	Ends of binding not finished as specified			305
Slide fastener	Not functioning properly, failing to effect a secure closure or to open freely	106		
	Slider jams or fails to interlock	107		
	Thong omitted	108		
	Damaged teeth	109		
Fastener tape	Any hole, cut or tear	110		
	Hooks flattened, broken or missing, impairing function	111		
Cloth	Any hole (except drill holes), cut, or tear	112		
	Exposed drill holes (i.e., not covered by attached parts)		202	
	Any abrasion marks, broken or missing yarns, or multiple floats clearly visible at normal inspection distance (3 feet)	113		
Screening	Any cut, tear, or hole noticeably larger than mesh openings	114		
	Edges of screen not caught in stitching as required	115		

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Webbing and tape	Any cut, tear or hole	116		
	Frayed or scalloped edges, not firmly or tightly woven		203	
Rope components: tent lines	Any cut or abrasion; any break		204	
	Free ends not finished as specified			306
	Knots, where required, not pulled tight mechanically and can be opened by hand			307
Hardware-general: metal and plastic	Broken or malformed; corroded area; burrs or shape edges, or missing	117		
	Finish omitted or not as specified	118		
	Any required component improperly installed causing failure to serve intended purpose	119		
Components and assembly	Any operation omitted or not performed in accordance with specification or drawing, unless classified herein	120		
Raw material	Any wrong material used	121		
Window panes	Edges of film not caught in stitching as required	122		
	Any holes	123		
Stitching margin	Larger or smaller than specified (including tolerance):			
	- for more than 2 inches but not more than 4 inches in length			308
	- for more than 4 inches in length		205	
Seams and stitching	Open seams:			
	- 1/2 inch or less			309
	- more than 1/2 inch	124		

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the pitch of biding as indicated below:

TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Seams and stitching (cont'd)	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as an open seam when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when two or more consecurive skipped or runoff stitches occur.			
Seam and stitch	Not specified seam or stitch type	125		
	Seam twisted, pleated or badly puckered (unless otherwise classified herein)			310
	Any line of stitching not beginning or ending where specified (unless otherwise classified herein)			311
	Any seam not lapped or finished as specified			312
Raw edge (on edge required to be finished	More than 1/2 inch in length when securely caught in stitching			313
	NOTE: Raw edge not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as an open seam.			
Thread breaks, skipped stitches or runoffs	On stitching other than box-x stitching, overstitched less than 1 inch in each direction beyond defective stitching area for 301 and 401 type stitching			314
	On box-x, overstitched less than 1/2 inch in each direction beyond the defective stitching area			315
	NOTE: Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or runoff stitches not overstitched shall be classified as open seams			

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Boxstitching	Incomplete:			
	- one row of stitching omitted		206	
	- two or more rows of stitching omitted		207	
	Any boxstitching less than specified length by more than 1/8 inch			316
Bartacking	Bartacking less than specified length by more or less than 1/8 inch			317
Stitching ends	Overstitched less than 1 inch on stitch type 301 or 401 (except where ends are held down by other stitching, turned under in a hem, or where stitching is performed automatically)		208	
	Secured with less than 3 tying, overlapping or backstitches when automatic stitching is performed		209	
Rows of stitching	One or more required rows of stitching omitted:			
	- Affecting serviceability seriously	126		
	- Affecting serviceability but not seriously			318
Bartacks	One or more bartacks omitted	127		
	Any bartack not as specified or not in specified location			319
	Loose stitching, incomplete or broken			320
Stitch tension	Tension loose, resulting in loose bobbin or top thread			321
	Tension tight, resulting in puckering of material			322
Stitches per inch	Less than minimum specified (except on panel joining seams)			
	- one stitch			323
	- two or more stitches		210	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Stitches per inch (cont'd)	Less than minimum specified on panel joining seams		211	
	More than maximum specified:			
	- one stitch			324
	- two or more stitches		212	
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch, caused by the operator speeding up the machine in order to sew over heavy pieces or heavy seams or in turning corners, shall be classified as follows:			
	a. Within the minor "A" defect classification - minor "B" defect			
	b. Within the minor "B" defect classification - no defect			
General	Any other construction details not performed as specified	128		
Lables	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or misplaced:			
	- erection or maintenance instructions		213	
	- identification			325
Cleanness	Grease or oil stains			326
	Thread ends not trimmed to 1/4 inch or less (except in slide fastener tape)			327
	Thread ends not trimmed to 1/4 inch or less in slide fastener area		214	

4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. Only those dimensions that can be evaluated without damaging or disassembling the end items shall be examined. The lot size shall be expressed in units of tents. The sample unit shall be

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one tent. The inspection level shall be S-I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 40 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE II. End item dimensional defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Dimensions: overall, on tent, fly and liner	Larger or smaller than specified (including applicable tolerances)	101	
Dimensions, other than overall, on tent fly and liner	Larger or smaller than specified (including applicable tolerances):		
	- affecting serviceability	102	
	- not affecting serviceability		201

4.4.5 End item testing. Tents shall be tested as specified in 4.5.1 and 4.5.2 for compliance with the requirements of 3.3.3, 3.3.1.1 and 3.6. The lot size shall be expressed in units of tent bodies. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated tent body. The inspection level shall be S-3. The lot shall be rejected if one or more sample units fail to meet the requirement.

4.4.6 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number per container is more or less than required

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4.4.7 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Load not bonded as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Wicking of sewing thread (cup test). The tent body assembly and any components utilizing transparent seam tape, shall be tested on any two areas as follows: any two seams on the tent assembly, and any two seams on the components utilizing seam tape. Suspend the seamed section of the test fabric in the center of a 6 ± 1/8 inch diameter hoop and form a depression with the seamed fabric in the hoop to a depth of 1 ± 1/4 inch. Slowly pour 500 mL of water at 77 ± 4°F into the cupped area (depression) and observe the under surface of the fabric for water penetration. Any wicking of water in any test area along the sewing thread, identified by a discoloration or darkening of the thread within 5 minutes after water is poured, shall constitute a test failure. Water leakage through the needle holes or between the plies of the lapped seamed fabric shall not be considered a failure.

4.5.2 Erection/striking of tent test. The complete tent assembly shall be erected/struck tested as follows:

a. The tent shall be unpacked and completely erected in accordance with Drawing No. 5-4-7676. All windows, doors, pockets, zippers and straps shall be operated to ensure performance.

b. After erection set-up is completed, the tent shall be completely struck (taken down), and packed.

The inability to erect/strike tent shall be considered a test failure.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A preservation.

5.1.1.1 Complete tent. Ten tent pins with bag (DWG. 5-4-7678), one complete Frame with bag (MIL-F-44425), one tent liner, one gear net, one fly, and one tent body, shall be folded compactly and rolled in a tent cover, which shall be wrapped and buckled. Final dimensions shall be approximately 38 inches by 16 inches by 16 inches.

5.1.2 Commercial preservation. Each complete tent or component shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Complete tent assembly preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a shipping container conforming to overseas type, style A, grade B of PPP-B-601. Approximate inside dimensions of the box shall be 38 inches in length, 16 inches in width, and 16 inches in depth. Each box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-601.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Complete tent assembly preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V3c of PPP-B-636. Approximate inside dimensions shall be 38 inches in length, 16 inches in width, and 16 inches in depth. Each box shall be closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Complete tents preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), complete tents packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type I or Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet types shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with straps in accordance with bonding means C and D or film bonding means F or G. Pallet pattern shall be 94 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers and unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

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6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The tent is intended for use by up to five soldiers with gear in all climatic conditions.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of tent required (see 1.2).
c. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
d. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
e. Levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Shelter

Custodian:

Army - GL

Review activity:

DLA - CT

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8340-A556)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-T-44427(GL)	1991 July 29

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

TENT, FIVE SOLDIER CREW

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON/DSN
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	508-651-4531	256-4531
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: STRNC-UXT Natick, MA 01760-5017	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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